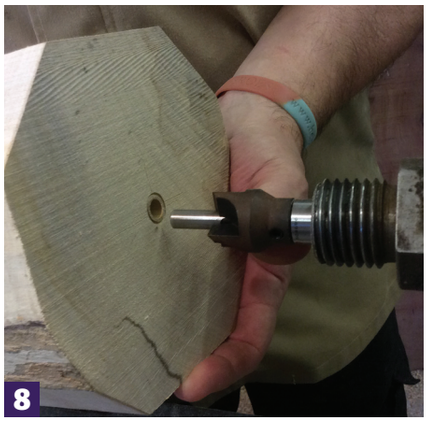
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8 Next, turn the blank around and drill in from the other side. Take the blank off the lathe and replace the headstock four-prong drive centre for the counterbore drive. The counterbore has a centre parallel bar that matches the auger diameter with four prongs around it, which creates a very positive drive. The other end of the lamp can now be drilled to meet up with your previous drilling at around the halfway point. Once that the centre hole has been drilled, rough down using a 30mm roughing gouge. There's no need to be fussy here as this is just preparation for drilling the base hole

9 Swap the counterbore head over from the drive to the boring head. This will be used to drill a second hole in the base that will later help with fitting the cable

10 Drill the base out using the boring head. You also need to drill a 7mm hole in from the side linking into this larger hole to be the route of the cable coming straight down the lamp and out to the side. When you've finished the boring, replace the boring head with the drive head ready for shaping the lamp

11 It's now time to start the turning. It's a good idea to have a drawing of your planned design beside you as you work. Start by shaping the base. Here, I've left a large, stable base before leading into a deep cove. The cover will finish with a fillet before moving into a convex curve to the highpoint about one-third up the height of the lamp

12 For the upper part of the lamp, start by taking off the bulk material using the roughing gouge. Work from the high point to create an ogee down to the next low point. As you can see, I've replaced the hollow live centre with a standard single pointed centre to add a bit more security while making these heavy cuts

13 When happy with the rough shape of the lamp, use the skew to iron out any lumps and bumps. Remember to always rub the bevel and cut with the supported bottom half of the chisel. Moving the toolrest slightly higher helps to keep that unsupported tip out of the way. Use bowl and spindle gouges on all the coves to give finishing cuts to match the skew finish. Then sand the piece down to 400grit

14 Seal the lamp with cellulose sanding sealer mixed to a 50/50 ratio with thinners. Once the sealer has dried, very lightly sand back with 600 grit at a low speed to de-nib. For the main finish, I chose a neutral paste wax to prevent yellowing. Apply the wax, then wait 10 minutes before burnishing off the excess, then buff with a piece of polishing cloth. This lamp was fitted with a flex cable, switched lamp holder, brass connecting plate and cable clamp

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